

The Team Sheet

You did the thirty days. This is how it survives four other people doing them badly.

WHAT HAS TO LEAVE YOUR LAPTOP

- **The rules file.** `CLAUDE.md` at the top of the project, committed. If it only exists on your machine, everybody else is working without it and nobody can see that.
- **The guards.** `.claude/settings.json` and `.claude/hooks`, committed. A guard nobody else has is a rule only you follow.
- **The saved jobs.** `.claude/skills/<name>.md`, committed. This is the part that pays for itself: one person writes the boring job once and four people stop doing it by hand.
- **The specialists.** `.claude/agents/<name>.md`, committed. The `tools` line in one is enforcement, not a suggestion, so it travels as a real limit.
- **Nothing else.** No keys, no personal settings, no transcripts. If it would embarrass you in a pull request, it does not belong in the repository.

SHARED OR PERSONAL

GOES IN THE REPOSITORY	STAYS ON YOUR MACHINE
The rules file for this project	Your own habits and shortcuts
Guards that must always run	Guards you are still trying out
Saved jobs the team repeats	One-off jobs only you run
Specialists with a fixed job	Anything holding a key or a token

THE RULE THAT KEEPS IT ALIVE

The rules file is corrected in the same commit as the mistake that proved it wrong. Written once and never touched again is the same as not having one, and everybody quietly stops reading it inside a month.

A NEW JOINER, FIRST THIRTY MINUTES

Install, on their own machine

```
curl -fsSL https://claude.ai/install.sh | bash
claude --version
```

Windows uses `irm https://claude.ai/install.ps1 | iex`. If it installs and will not log in, that is the account, not the install.

Open the project, not a folder of notes

```
claude
```

Started inside the repository, so it reads the rules file the team already wrote.

Show them what is enforced

```
/hooks
```

Read only, and it lists exactly what will block them. Far better than finding out by being blocked.

WHAT BREAKS THE MOMENT A SECOND PERSON JOINS

Everybody writes their own rules file

One file, in the project, in the repository. Personal preferences go in the user level file instead, where they cannot argue with the team's.

A guard blocks somebody and they cannot tell why

Make the guard say what it wants. It sends its message back when it refuses, so write that line for the colleague who has never seen it, not for yourself.

Two people build the same saved job, slightly differently

Search `.claude/skills` before writing one. Thirty seconds of looking beats two versions that drift apart for six months.

The person who set it up leaves

Nothing happens, if everything above is committed. The setup is plain files that live with the project, handed over by copying a folder rather than a person.

WHAT TO STANDARDISE, AND WHAT TO LEAVE ALONE

- **Standardise what must not happen.** Anything that would be expensive to undo goes in a guard, and everybody gets the same one.
- **Standardise the boring repeated job.** That is where the hours are, and a shared version gets better every time somebody fixes it.
- **Leave the way people work alone.** How somebody phrases a request is not a team decision, and policing it buys nothing while costing you goodwill.